

To: Prof. Johannes Bjerva

Email: jbjerva@cs.aau.dk

Subject: Application for Four PhD Positions in NLP, AI and LLM Security — Ref [TODO: verify with user]
— Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Prof. Bjerva,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD position in NLP, AI, and LLM Security at Aalborg University Copenhagen, under your supervision. I am eager to contribute to the research themes of LLM security and safety, privacy in NLP/AI, and robustness analysis across language settings. My earliest start date would be 1 September 2026, aligning with the position's requirements.

Your paper, [TODO: verify supervisor paper title via Google Scholar], particularly inspires my application. The depth of exploration into multilinguality and its implications for LLM security resonates with my academic and professional pursuits, and I am keen to contribute to this area of research.

My MSc in Business Analytics from Aston University, where I achieved a First Class (1:1) distinction, has equipped me with strong skills in machine learning and deep learning, particularly in modern NLP methods including transformer models. My dissertation, *"Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis: A Smart Contract Approach"*, involved fine-tuning the DeBERTa-v3 transformer on multi-tier supplier review data, which aligns with your focus on transformer models and NLP.

In my role as a Data Scientist & Project Manager at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department, I led the development of automated ETL pipelines and self-service dashboards, embedding data governance and privacy practices throughout. This experience honed my skills in data efficiency and project delivery, which are crucial for the research themes of data poisoning detection and adversarial inputs.

Additionally, my project, *LLM-Generated Adaptive Shipper Decision Rules (LLM-Shipper-Profiles)*, involved building an end-to-end RAG system using OpenAI's gpt-4o-mini, augmented with retrieval over a curated behavioural-literature knowledge base. This project underscores my capability in LLM application and reproducibility, directly relevant to the themes of LLM-generated text detection and robustness analysis.

I acknowledge that my academic background in Business Analytics, rather than pure Computer Science, may present a gap. However, my extensive practical experience in NLP and AI, coupled with my ongoing training in NLP engineering, positions me to effectively contribute to your research group.

I have attached my CV, research statement, and transcripts for your review. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to join your team and contribute to pioneering research in LLM security and AI.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of discussing how I can contribute to your research group.

Sincerely,

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